



SMART GLAMOUR ROOMS

From mirrors that don't fog to intelligent water closets to sustainable showers, bathrooms are fast becoming hi-tech

BY SMITA TRIPATHI



I **MAGINE GOING TO THE** toilet in the morning and as you sit down comfortably for your daily ablutions, your phone pings. “Your diet seems unbalanced. The recommended recipe is: ‘Salmon/Chicken Avocado Salad.’” No, the message is not from your nutritionist, but from your toilet. Yes, that’s right, your toilet doubles up as a health monitoring device. Welcome to the future where your toilet does the talking.

Japan-based Toto presented the Wellness Toilet concept at this year’s Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas, giving us a glimpse into the bathroom of the future. Using “multiple cutting-edge sensing technologies”, each time a person sits on the toilet, it will track and analyse a person’s “mental and physical status”, says the company. This data will then be sent to an app to provide users with recommendations. Of course, this is still a prototype and probably years away from commercial manufacturing.

However, bathrooms today are pretty hi-tech. “After kitchens, if there’s an area big on technological advancements, it is the bathroom space. Countries such as Japan and the US were already using hi-tech toilets but recently, we have seen this trend pick up in our home ground too,” says Payal Bagzai, Head of Design at Livspace, a home interiors company.

From sensor- or touch-operated taps and shower systems to intelligent toilet seats with automated seat covers that open and close pre-and post-usage